

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Can you give me your opinion?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- What fields are easy to start working in? Why?
- What fields are more difficult to start in? Why?
- What advice would you give to someone who wants to work in your field?

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use the sound *spr*.
- I can use proper intonation in long questions.
- I can exchange opinions about jobs and work.





Let's Explore!

Sally and Peter talk about breaking into the **field*** ... of journalism.

* The word "field" can mean a real physical space, like a soccer field, or a concept, like a career field.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hi Peter! How are things?
Peter: Not very good. I sprained my ankle playing soccer.
Sally: Soccer? Already?
Peter: Yes, now that it's spring, we play soccer outdoors.
Sally: How did it happen?
Peter: I was sprinting towards the ball, but then I tripped in some mud. I sprawled onto the field with my legs spread out like an eagle.
Sally: Ouch!
Peter: How are you doing?
Sally: I'm good. I just got an interesting e-mail from a young woman starting a career in journalism.
Peter: What did you tell her?
Sally: I told her I thought it was a good idea to take some courses and get some freelance experience.
Peter: Do you think it is difficult for someone who wants to start working in journalism to break into the field?
Sally: It can be tough. In my opinion, it's important to get experience. I told her she could write articles for *Cambridge Life*.
Peter: How challenging do you think it is for a new journalist to find stories that appeal to a wide audience?
Sally: I don't think it's very difficult. You have to engage with people and listen to their comments.
Peter: She could write about the dangers of running on a soccer field in the spring!
Sally: OK, good idea!



Let's Practice!

Peter asks Sally some long questions. Does he use correct intonation?

Instructions: Read the questions. Circle all the words that emphasize new information. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) Do you think it is difficult for someone who wants to start working in journalism to break into the field?
- 2) How challenging do you think it is for a new journalist to find stories that appeal to a wide audience?



Let's Practice!

Spring* has sprung**! Let's practice the *spr* consonant blend!

* In this case, "spring" is the season (March - May). *To spring* means to jump or to come up.

** "Sprung" is the past form of the verb *to spring*

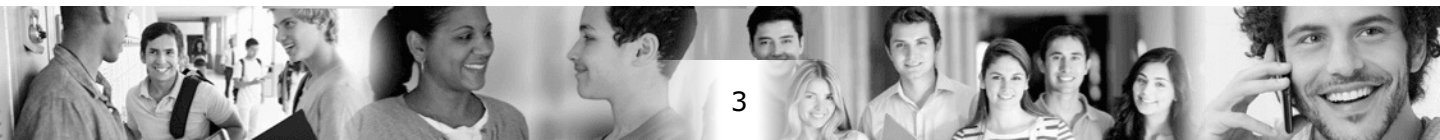
Instructions: Organize the mystery words and the mystery sentences. Read the words and sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) Pwrsal _____ 2) parish _____ 3) psgirn _____ 4) psaedr _____

5) was / sprinting / in / tripped / some / mud. / but / ball, / I / towards / then / I / the

6) sprawled / with / field / out / eagle. / spread / like / my / onto / the / an / I / legs

7) we / play / it's / soccer / outdoors. / that / spring, / Now





Extension Activity

Role-play a debate between two people who have different opinions about a career field.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, choose a field of work, like acting in movies, business or medicine.
- Choose roles. One person thinks it is easy to break into this field. The other person thinks it is difficult.
- Before you start the role play, plan your ideas separately. Try to think of 3 - 4 reasons for your opinion. Do not talk about them.
- Write key words to help you give your opinion.
- Complete the role play. Make sure you use expressions like "In my opinion ..." or "I don't think ..."
- Try to keep the conversation going for 5 minutes.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write key words about a career field.

☐ ☐

I engage in a role play about a career field.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate expressions to give my opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to sprawl** (verb): to stretch out in an unusual way
e.g. I tripped in some mud and sprawled onto the field.
- spring** (noun): in North America, the period of the year from March to June
e.g. Now that it's spring, we play soccer outdoors.
- spread out** (adjective): extended open, covering a large area (like open wings, arms or legs)
e.g. I tripped in some mud and fell onto the field with my legs spread out like an eagle.
- to sprint** (verb): to run very quickly for a short time
e.g. I was sprinting towards the ball when I tripped in some mud.
- to trip** (verb): to fall because of something on the ground
e.g. I tripped in some mud as I was playing soccer.
- eagle** (noun): a large predatory bird, often used as a symbol because of its wide wings
e.g. I sprawled onto the field with my legs spread out like an eagle.
- to break into the field** (expression): to start working in an area
e.g. As a new journalist, is it difficult to break into the field?





Learning Points

Consonant Blends - The *spr* Sound

Consonant clusters like /*spr*/ can occur at the beginning of a word in English.

Practice blending the sound from one consonant into the next without adding a vowel in between.

Read the following words aloud.

spring	sprawl	sprain	spread
spray	sprint	springboard	sprinkler

Examples:

- *I was sprinting towards the ball, but then I tripped in some mud and sprawled onto the field with my legs spread out like an eagle.*
- *Now that it's spring, we play soccer outdoors.*





Learning Points

Intonation in Long Questions

Intonation is important in statements and in long questions. You use the rise and fall of your voice to show the listener when you are or are not finished.

In long questions, the intonation falls and then rises to show the question is not finished.

Normally, you place an extra emphasis on some important verbs, adjectives and nouns in the question.

At the end, the intonation rises or falls, depending on whether it is a yes/no or information question.

Say these sentences. Place extra emphasis on the bolded words. Be sure to notice if the question is a yes/no or information question.

You don't **think** that **computers** help people **connect** with each other?

Do you **mean** you don't enjoy the **time** you spend **online**?

Don't you **think** you should try to **adapt** instead?

Examples:

- Do you think it is **difficult** for someone who wants to **start** working in journalism to **break into** the field?
- How **challenging** do you think it is for a **new** journalist it to find **stories** that appeal to a **wide** audience?

